# UMESH GAUTAM

Department of Agricultural & Applied Economics | Texas Tech University | Lubbock, TX

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## EDUCATION

**Ph.D. in Applied Economics**, Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX — Expected Spring 2027

**M.S. in Applied Economics**, Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX — Expected Fall 2026

**M.A. in Economics**, Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX — 2022

**Bachelor of Business Administration**, Kathmandu University, Nepal — 2017

## RESEARCH FIELDS

International Trade | Industrial Organization | Labor Economics | Production Economics

I develop structural economic models and employ advanced econometric methods, including causal inference, and calibration to evaluate policies by analyzing their effects on trade, production, prices, employment, wages, and welfare across different market structures.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

### Publications

1. Devadoss, S., and **U. Gautam***. 2026. **Implications of Mass Deportation for US Vegetable Production.** *Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics* 51(3): 537–553. DOI: 10.22004/ag.econ.376283.
2. **Gautam, U.**, and S. Devadoss. 2026. **Impacts of Deportation on Employment, Wages, and Output in California Vegetable Production.** *Applied Economics Education and Extension* 8(2). DOI: 10.71162/aeee.358040.
3. **Gautam, U.**, and S. Devadoss. 2027 (Forthcoming). **Implications of Stricter Immigration Policies for US Fruit Production.** *Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics.*

* Authorship is shared equally.

### Papers Under Review

1. **Gautam, U.**, and S. Devadoss. 2026. **Does Market Conduct Matter? Evidence from Global Tree-Nut Trade.** (Job Market Paper)
   Global tree-nut trade is modeled using structural gravity with endogenous markups and a representative multiproduct firm in each exporting country. Perfect, monopolistic, Bertrand, and Cournot competition are evaluated against observed trade shares, with Cournot providing the best fit. A free-trade counterfactual predicts substantial differences in trade reallocation and welfare across forms of market conduct. Results remain robust when allowing more symmetric firms per exporting country.
2. **Gautam, U.**, W. Blundell, S. Devadoss, and J. Luckstead. 2026. **Effects of Mergers and Acquisitions on Retail Prices.**

### Research in Progress

1. **Gautam, U.**, and S. Devadoss. 2026. **Pharmaceutical Mergers, Market Power, and Drug Prices in the United States.**
2. **Gautam, U.**, and S. Devadoss. 2026. **Implications of Tariff Policies in the U.S. Automobile Industry.**
3. Aryal, S., S. Devadoss, and **U. Gautam**. 2026. **Critical Mineral Trade: A Structural Gravity Analysis.**

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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|---|---|
| **Independent Instructor**, AAEC 2301: Agricultural Statistics | Expected Spring 2027 |
| **Independent Instructor**, AAEC 2305: Fundamentals of Ag. & Applied Economics | Fall 2026 |
| **Teaching Assistant**, AAEC 6315: Applied Microeconomics I (Ph.D.) | Spring 2026 |
| **Teaching Assistant**, AAEC 6315: Applied Microeconomics I (Ph.D.) | Spring 2024 |
| **Teaching Assistant**, ECO 3311: Intermediate Macroeconomics | Fall 2021 |
| **Teaching Assistant**, ECO 5314: Econometrics | Fall 2020 |
| **Teaching Assistant**, ECO 2305: Principles of Economics | Spring 2020 |
| **Teaching Assistant**, ECO 2305: Principles of Economics | Fall 2019 |

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

**Gautam, U.**, and S. Devadoss, **"Effects of Immigration Enforcement in the U.S. Fruit Sector,"**

Presented at the Western Agricultural Economics Association, Flagstaff, Arizona, June 21–23, 2026.

**Gautam, U.**, and S. Devadoss, **"Implications of Mass Deportation for U.S. Vegetable Production,"**

Presented at the Southern Agricultural Economics Association Annual Meeting, Louisville, Kentucky, February 2026.

**Gautam, U.**, and S. Devadoss, **"Implications of Mass Deportation for U.S. Vegetable Production,"**

Presented at the Three Minute Thesis (3MT) Competition, Texas Tech University, October 2025.

**Gautam, U.**, and S. Devadoss, **"Implications of Mass Deportation for U.S. Vegetable Production,"**

Presented at the Davis College Poster Competition, Texas Tech University, October 2025.

## HONORS & AWARDS

**Bloom Award** April 2026
Spring into Discovery Research Slam Competition, Texas Tech University.
**Consequences of Stricter Immigration Enforcement for U.S. Vegetable Production.**

Summer Thesis/Dissertation Research Award, Texas Tech University 2025

Graduate Student Mentor, Davis College Gordon and Joyce Davis Endowed Scholarship, Texas Tech University 2025

Graduate Student Mentor, Davis College Gordon and Joyce Davis Endowed Scholarship, Texas Tech University 2024

## HONORS & AWARDS (CONTINUED)

Study Abroad Competitive Scholarship, Texas Tech University 2020

Winner, Advertisement Competition, Kathmandu, Nepal 2017

First Runner-up, National Management Festival, Kathmandu, Nepal 2016

Global Commitment Award, Global Enterprise Experience, New Zealand 2015

## RESEARCH GRANTS

"Ethnic Population in the United States and Vegetable Imports" (2025)

Davis College Undergraduate Research Grant, Texas Tech University | $12,000

Project Director: Stephen Devadoss | Undergraduate Student: Shin Naing
Graduate Student Mentor: **Umesh Gautam**

"U.S.-Mexico GM Corn Trade Dispute" (2024)

Davis College Undergraduate Research Grant, Texas Tech University | $12,000

Project Director: Stephen Devadoss | Undergraduate Student: Chase Hall
Graduate Student Mentor: **Umesh Gautam**

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

R | Stata | Python | LaTeX/LyX

## JOURNAL REFEREE

*Applied Economics Education and Extension*

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

**Session Moderator**, "Labor, Automation, and Migration," WAEA Annual Meeting June 2026

**Coordinator**, Annual Co-Curricular Events, Kathmandu University, Nepal 2016

**Organizer**, Annual Co-Curricular Events, Kathmandu University, Nepal 2014

**Organizer**, KUSOM Annual Festival, Kathmandu University, Nepal 2014–2016

## VOLUNTEER SERVICE

**Volunteer**, Eco-Carnival, Kathmandu University, Nepal 2013–2015

## REFERENCES

**Dr. Stephen Devadoss** | Professor and Emabeth Thompson Endowed Professor

Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, Texas Tech University | stephen.devadoss@ttu.edu

**Dr. Benaissa Chidmi** | Associate Professor

Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, Texas Tech University | benaissa.chidmi@ttu.edu

**Dr. Michael Noel** | Professor

Department of Economics, Texas Tech University | michael.noel@ttu.edu

**Dr. Jeffrey Luckstead** | Distinguished Professor of Agricultural and Resource Economics

School of Economic Sciences, Washington State University | jluckstead@wsu.edu